

Lesson 6: "I Will Tell You in Your Mind and in Your Heart by the Holy Ghost"

Purpose: To help us learn to recognize personal revelation through the Holy Ghost and encourage us to seek this blessing in our lives. ⇨ Elder Boyd K. Packer

1. Understanding how the Holy Ghost communicates with us.

A. D&C 8:2-3; 85:6 *He uses a still, small voice to communicate to our minds and hearts.*

(1 Kings 19:12; 1 Ne. 17:45; Hel. 5:30)

⇨ Elder Dallin H. Oaks ⇨ Elder Boyd K. Packer ⇨ Elder Dallin H. Oaks ⇨ President Spencer W. Kimball

B. D&C 6:15; 11:12-14 *He enlightens our minds, which fills our souls with joy.* (Gal. 5:22-23; D&C 50:23-24)

The Prophet Joseph Smith said: "The Spirit of Revelation is in connection with these blessings. A person may profit by noticing the first intimation of the spirit of revelation; for instance, when you feel pure intelligence flowing into you, it may give you sudden strokes of ideas, so that by noticing it, you may find it fulfilled the same day or soon; (i.e.) those things that were presented into your minds by the Spirit of God [Sec. 85:6; Enos 10] will come to pass; and thus by learning the Spirit of God and understanding it, you may grow in the principle of revelation, until you become perfect in Christ Jesus." (History of the Church, 3:381; emphasis added)

C. D&C 6:22-23 *He brings peace to our minds.*

MEMBER EXPERIENCES SHARED:

D. D&C 9:7-9 *He may cause a burning in the bosom.*

President Boyd K. Packer: "This burning in the bosom is not purely a physical sensation. It is more like a warm light shining within your being." (Ensign, Nov. 1994, 60) ⇨ Elder Dallin H. Oaks

E. D&C 98:12 *He often reveals things "line upon line, precept upon precept" rather than all at once.*

Elder Richard G. Scott said: "When we seek inspiration to help make decisions, the Lord gives gentle promptings. These require us to think, to exercise faith, to work, to struggle at times, and to act. Seldom does the whole answer to a decisively important matter or complex problem come all at once. More often, it comes a piece at a time, without the end in sight." (Ensign, Nov. 1989, 32)

Q: HOW HAVE WE RECEIVED REVELATIONS LINE UPON LINE?

2. Cautions about personal revelation.

A. D&C 109:44 *We should pray that the Lord's will be done" and be willing to submit our will to His.*

WHAT ARE SOME REASONS THIS WOULD BE IMPORTANT?

HOW SHOULD WE RESPOND WHEN A SINCERE PRAYER ABOUT SOMETHING WE DESIRE A LOT IS NOT ANSWERED THE WAY WE WANT? HOW CAN SUCH EXPERIENCES HELP US?

B. D&C 88:68 *We should remember that revelation will come in the Lord's own time and way.*

⇨ Elder Dallin H. Oaks

C. D&C 28:2, 6-7; 43:2-4 *We receive revelation according to our stewardship and responsibilities.*

⇨ The Prophet Joseph Smith ⇨ Elder Dallin H. Oaks

D. D&C 11:12-14; 50:23-24 *We should discern whether the revelation has come from God.*

⇨ The First Presidency

3. When revelation is not received or recognized.

WHAT SHOULD WE DO WHEN PERSONAL REVELATION DOES NOT COME WHEN WE DESIRE IT?

D&C 98:2; ISAIAH 59:2; D&C 58:25-28; 60:5; 61:22; 62:5

⇨ Elder Boyd K. Packer

4. Caution about revelation for marriage.

Elder John H. Groberg wrote: "I would ... caution you that you cannot receive a one-sided revelation from God in regards to an eternal marriage. Only as both parties feel the same way can you have the assurance that it is from the Lord. Those who try to force another's free will into their supposed-revelation mold are doing a great disservice to themselves and to their friends." ("What Are You Doing Here?" New Era, Jan. 1987, 37-38) ⇨ ⇨

Next Week: Lesson 7 "The First Principles and Ordinances of the Gospel"

Oscar W. McConkie: “The administration of angels need not be as dramatic as were those of the restoring agents from on high. Angels may minister and the recipient need not know the source of his strength or joy. For example, one person may be helped while speaking from the pulpit, while another may receive guidance at a critical junction in his life. In some instances a third party has been aware of the presence of angels while the party actually concerned was apparently unaware of their presence.” (*Aaronic Priesthood*, 101)

Elder James M. Paramore had a friend in Alaska who didn’t know how to build a two-story home. He had an instruction book for one-story homes and some experience, but he had no idea how to add the second story. At the site he pleaded with Heavenly Father to teach him how.

As he prayed, he felt the presence of another person. He looked, saw no one, but continued to feel the presence of that person who then said, “If you’ll be quiet, I’ll tell you how to build your home. I’m a builder from Utah and Heavenly Father sent me here to help you build your home.”

This builder from Utah worked with Elder Paramore’s friend for the space of the whole day and at the end of the day said, “That’s all you need from me. I need to be going. I have some other assignments to fill.” (Elder James M. Paramore, Stake Conference Talk “A Church of Miracles,” Monterey Stake Conference, 29 Sep 1985)

Elder Boyd K. Packer: “These delicate, refined spiritual communications are not seen with our eyes nor heard with our ears. And even though it is described as a voice, it is a voice that one feels more than one hears.” (*That All May Be Edified*, 335)

Elder Dallin H. Oaks: “Some [people] have looked exclusively for the great manifestations that are recorded in the scriptures and have failed to recognize the still, small voice that is given to them.... We need to know that the Lord rarely speaks loudly. His messages almost always come in a whisper....

“Not understanding these principles of revelation, some people postpone acknowledging their testimony until they have experienced a miraculous event. They fail to realize that with most people ... gaining a testimony is not an event but a process.” (*Ensign*, Mar. 1997, 11-12, 14)

President Spencer W. Kimball: “I have often told the story of a young man who was promised safe return from World War II but who found himself in a terrifying and hazardous situation on the beach-heads of Italy. After three strong impressions came to him, he moved from the spot where he was looking at his map to deploy his soldiers, and immediately after his moving, a bomb came from the skies and blew up everything in the area where he had stood.” (*Faith Precedes the Miracle*, 29)

Elder Dallin H. Oaks: “I have met persons who told me they have never had a witness from the Holy Ghost because they have never felt their bosom ‘burn within’ them. What does a ‘burning in the bosom’ mean? Does it need to be a feeling of caloric heat, like the burning produced by combustion? If that is the meaning, I have never had a burning in the bosom. Surely, the word ‘burning’ in this scripture signifies a feeling of comfort and serenity.”

Elder Dallin H. Oaks: “The Lord will speak to us through the Spirit in his own time and in his own way. Many people do not understand this principle. They believe that when they are ready and when it suits their convenience, they can call upon the Lord and he will immediately respond, even in the precise way they have prescribed. Revelation does not come that way....

“The principle stated in [D&C 88:68] applies to every communication from our Heavenly Father: ‘It shall be in his own time, and in his own way, and according to his own will.’ We cannot force spiritual things.” (*Ensign*, Mar. 1997, 10-11)

The Prophet Joseph Smith: “It is contrary to the economy of God for any member of the Church, or any one, to receive instruction for those in authority higher than themselves.” (*Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, 21)

Dallin H. Oaks: “Our Heavenly Father’s house is a house of order.... Only the President of the Church receives revelation to guide the entire Church.... The person who receives revelation for the ward is the bishop.... Individuals can receive revelation to guide their own lives. But when one person purports to receive revelation for another person outside his or her own area of responsibility—such as a Church member who claims to have revelation to guide the entire Church or a person who claims to have a revelation to guide another person over whom he or she has no presiding authority according to the order of the Church—you can be sure that such revelations are not from the Lord.” (“Revelation,” *New Era*, Sept. 1982, 45-46)

The First Presidency: “When ... inspiration conveys something out of harmony with the accepted revelations of the Church or contrary to the decisions of its constituted authorities, Latter-day Saints may know that it is not of God, no matter how plausible it may appear.... Anything at discord with that which comes from God through the head of the Church is not to be received as authoritative or reliable.” (in James R. Clark, comp., *Messages of the First Presidency of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints*, 6 vols. [1965-75], 4:285)

Elder Boyd K. Packer: “Sometimes you may struggle with a problem and not get an answer. What could be wrong? It may be that you are not doing anything wrong. It may be that you have not done the right things long enough. Remember, you cannot force spiritual things. Sometimes we are confused simply because we won’t take no for an answer....

“Put difficult questions in the back of your minds and go about your lives. Ponder and pray quietly and persistently about them.

“The answer may not come as a lightning bolt. It may come as a little inspiration here and a little there, ‘line upon line, precept upon precept.’ (D&C 98:12)

“Some answers will come from reading the scriptures, some from hearing speakers. And, occasionally, when it is important, some will come by very direct and powerful inspiration. The promptings will be clear and unmistakable.” (*Ensign*, Nov. 1979, 21)